

Violet Lunt Urie
10 August 1873 - 7 February 1967

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--Marian H. Monson

My name is Violet Urie. I am now 87 years of age, having been born in Cedar City, Utah, August 10, 1873, of goodly parents, Henry and Mary Ann Wilson Lunt. I say of goodly parents, because they were good. They obeyed the commandments of the Lord; they were good neighbors, true friends, and worthy parents.

I want to tell my story not for anyone but my family. It is to be my story, not that of my parents, my sisters, nor my brothers except as their stories relate to mine. It is not to be the story of my city, my neighbors, nor my friends. Yet stories of each could be told, for I have seen remarkable things happen during my lifetime.

I have seen a community rise up and shoulder the responsibility of providing an institution of higher learning. I have seen men give vast tracts of land for that project. I saw them mortgage their homes to provide money to meet the costs of building that school. I saw men including my brother Randle go to the mountain in the dead of winter to get lumber for the building. That building was the first of a number of buildings which is now College of Southern Utah.

I saw men sacrifice to build canals and to bring water into our town. I saw men work together to give us services as telephones and electricity. The women, too, sacrificed and worked to build our community. They sewed and cooked and worked in the corrals and went to the mountains to do dairy work. They took care of their men and made life a little easier for everyone but themselves in this land of struggle and hard work.

Despite hardships and struggle, life is very bounteous and full of joy. My life has been a dream, a skip, a hop, and a song. Yet many sad things have happened. It makes me cry when I think of some of the things. Some of the families of our town went to Mexico to escape persecution for their beliefs. Included in this group was my own father. We know that they and their families escaped with their very lives in persecutions there.

I know that there are undercurrents in community building, but that people rise above them. I know that leadership is not always accepted and that the uninformed often stand in the way of progress. Yet right does prevail and these sadnesses are but passing minutes of time and they add their contributions to building for bigger and better things.

Each morning when I arise I think of the wonderful things which will happen to me this day. I think also of what has been wonderful to me in the past. I have faltered at times, but I go to the Lord and ask His forgiveness and then go on from there. I have found life beautiful. Even now I awake with a song on my lips. This morning I sang, "How beautiful upon the mountains, Are the feet of Him who . . ." I sing softly for being in an apartment house one should not disturb others. Whether one sings softly or with volume, one can feel the influence of a good song.

I learned at a very early age that there were other things to talk about besides the foibles and

mistakes of others. When I was but a small child, Aunt Ellen would ask if I wanted to sit by her while she and Mother visited. She would pull up a little chair and I would sit and hold my doll as she and Mother talked as they sewed. I never heard complaints nor names of people in those conversations. I often knew they were referring to people, but they guarded their conversation.

Aunt Ellen wasn't my real aunt. She was my father's first wife. My father was a polygamist. He was the father of 24 children. It is nothing of which to be ashamed. We all had a fine heritage from our parents. They gave us good teachings, and each of our mothers worked well with our father in providing for our needs, educating us, and giving the proper discipline when needed.

We had our private families and our whole family, and we got along well. We each loved our brothers and sisters. As far as I know there was nothing but love and understanding among all my brothers and sisters. I have loved each up to the time he or she left this earth, and those who remain still have my love. What people do not seem to understand is the wonderful family relationships that polygamy produced. We loved Aunt Ellen as much as we could love anyone who was not our own mother. She was a second mother to us. She had no children. We loved our brothers and sisters and only those who have had such brothers and sisters can realize the sacrifices and understanding families can have for one another.

My father and some of his family moved to Mexico. Because my brothers and sisters in our private family were married and had families of their own, they stayed in Cedar City. My mother, getting along in years, stayed here too.

Although I have said that this is to be my story, I have digressed but would like to tell a little more of Aunt Ellen and Father. Aunt Ellen was a beautiful seamstress and her talents went to help provide for all of father's family. Her devotion was shown when Father was called on a mission to Great Britain, the land of his birth. He was born in Cheshire, England, July 20, 1824. He died in Pacheco, Mexico, January 22, 1902. Having been called on a mission, he left Aunt Ellen in Cedar City, to make her way as best she could. He did not have a suit of clothing thought suitable for him to go back to England in which to meet his people. Aunt Ellen made him a suit from her best serge dress. The suit apparently was beautifully tailored, and it fit Father perfectly, but its blue color and the material were not what men's suits were made of. When Father met the missionaries with whom he was to go to England, the leader of the group said, "Brother Lunt, we'll need to buy you a suit of clothing. You cannot go to England in that suit." Father must have felt very unhappy, for after Aunt Ellen's sacrifice and work, the suit was not considered good enough. The brethren loaned Father money and he purchased a most elegant suit. He went to England well dressed. With money which his family gave him he was able to repay the men who had given him money for the suit.

It was while in England at this time that Father met Mother, Mary Ann Wilson. She became converted to the church, was baptized, and came to America. Mother was born in Carlisle, England, January 19, 1834. She died April 7, 1910, in Cedar City. Mother was a school teacher when only 16 years of age. She was an orphan, and her uncle had provided her with an education. She had a beautiful soprano voice and had appeared before Queen Victoria in a command performance. Mother distributed her talent to each of her daughters, but their ranges were from soprano to contralto.

Mother learned to know Aunt Ellen because of Father's devotion to her. While in England Mother wrote a poem and gave it to Father. It was inscribed to "Mrs. Henry Lunt," our Aunt Ellen. Here is the poem. The young missionary sent it to his wife and said: "I received the following lines from Mary Ann Wilson of Carlisle, England, inscribed to Mrs. Henry Lunt":

In Ephraim's vale a floweret bloomed
 Surpassing lovely was its hue.
 It spread its fragrance all around
 The pleasant spot on which it grew.
 Yet so lovely and so sweet,
 'Twas full of grace and modesty
 And strove to hide its loveliness
 From the rude gaze of passers-by.
 But there was one of splendid form
 Of graceful mien and noble worth
 Who chanced to see its tiny head
 And not because of gorgeous tints
 Of dazzling beauty 'twas arrayed
 But for the unassuming grace
 That threw a halo round its head.
 So when he saw its tender stem
 And thought of storms that might arise
 And blight its lovely beauteous bloom,
 He gently plucked the dear loved prize
 And in his bosom safely placed
 This sweet and fragrant flower,
 And there it blooms secure from harm
 And every blighting power.
 This flower an emblem is, or her
 Who is the hope and joy of life
 Of one of Israel's noble sons,
 His dear and fondly cherished wife.
 O still may she in beauty bloom
 And dwell in peace and sweet content
 And bless with pure devoted love
 Her honored husband Henry Lunt.

This helps show the devotion that our family had even before its beginning. Now back to my story.

One of the most unforgettable things of my life was when Eliza R. Snow came to Cedar City in 1880 to organize a Primary Association. I was about six, and there were perhaps twenty of us who were charter members of that Primary. During the organization meeting Sister Snow showed us a watch which had been the Prophet Joseph's. She told us about the Prophet and the watch. She let each of us hold the watch for a short time. I remember as I held the watch in my tiny cupped hands, she gave us an admonition not to ever forget that we had held the Prophet's watch. I believe that I am the only one living who was in that group. I imagine the rest remembered, as I shall always, the story Sister Snow told us of the Prophet and of the wonderful moment when we held his watch. In my later life I became president of the Primary and I tried to live up to all of the precepts and admonitions that Sister Snow gave us that day. I remember Eliza R. Snow for another reason. It was she who came to Cedar City to encourage the production of silk. Many families obtained silk worms, and it was the delight of the children to go to someone's home and see the little worms on curtains, in cupboards, and about the house, but mostly in windows and on curtains. It was a delight to gather leaves and take them to the homes where the worms were the most numerous. After being invited in with our small offerings of leaves, we would sit and watch the worms at their work. There was no end of fascination in the spinning of cocoons.

The silk industry didn't go as well in Cedar City as it had in St. George, but before we knew the worms wouldn't do well here mulberry trees had been planted all over town. It wasn't too long before our sidewalks were covered with purple fruit and children would go to school with purple-stained hands, faces, and clothing. Eventually the mulberry trees were all taken out and mostly they were replaced with other trees.

The next event in my religious life which stand as a great day was the day of my baptism. Since my diary has been the outline from which my life story is now being written, I'll quote directly from it:

Baptised Aug. 10, 1881 in the old creek. This was a wonderful day in my life. Many of my little playmates gathered and a party was to be given after the baptismal ceremony. Father invited Brother Richard Palmer to assist him so off we went down to the creek. I walked holding the hands of my father and Brother Palmer, my friends marching in the rear. Father baptized me and Brother Palmer confirmed me. Father wrapped a dry shawl around me and carried me home. We had a grand party and I have never forgotten the solemnity and joy of that day.

It was customary for us to be baptized on our birthdays. Winter or summer, the creek was the place of baptism. The "baptismal font" was located in Coal Creek, which runs through Cedar City in the east section. The spot was near the bridge just north of 200 North Street. Because a fairly deep pool was needed, a temporary dam had been built of rocks and mud. Since my baptism was in August, the creek was probably low, especially if it followed the pattern that the stream flow follows today. Complete immersion is practiced in baptism and I heard of at least one case in my youth where the stream wasn't deep enough to baptize an eight-year-old boy. After repeated tries to baptize him, the ordinance was not completed at that time. After several tries the boy broke away from those performing the service and cried as he ran, "I'll be baptized when you can catch me." He was baptized later, but not on his birthday as had been originally planned.

There was a baptismal font which later came into use and was used quite extensively. That was the tanning vat at a tannery we had in Cedar City.

I attended Sister Chaffin's school. The school was a small lumber room on the southeast corner of First East at Center Street. I believe the church built the school for Sister Chaffin. Sister Chaffin seemed to me to be an old, old lady when I went to her school. Sister Chaffin would stand on a little platform in the front of the room, and along the other three walls were benches with little narrow tables in front of them. Pupils sat on the benches. In the corner in the back of the room was a pot-bellied wood-burning stove. The boys used to leave the school room between classes to go outside to chop wood for the stove. We studied such subjects as spelling, mathematics, reading, and writing. I remember spelling down a big boy and the impression was so vividly implanted on me that I recall the word: it was "saucer."

We used stone slates and wrote with charcoal. Between uses of the charcoal it was customary for us to wipe the writing or figures off with a rolling motion of the fleshy part of our forearm. It wasn't above us to spit on the slates to clean them a little better and make them really neat-looking. Our sleeves from the elbows down were always a tell-tale that we were going to school.

I attended this school for two or three years. Nearly all of the children of the community from 5 or 6 to 14 or 15 attended. Tuition was paid by our parents. It was \$3.00 a term. However, some children did not attend school, and some only a few terms.

I know people now who are younger than I who cannot trust themselves to write letters. What a joy it would be in their old age to be able to keep interest through correspondence with their children, friends, and relatives. Many parents could have afforded to send their sons and daughters to Mrs. Chaffin's school, but the parents felt it more important to use the money for other things. They thought it better for their children to work to build up family businesses or incomes. I have seen men and women who were highly competent in business matters hindered greatly because of lack of schooling.

While I was going to school we had winter snows that would leave three or more feet of snow. We wrapped our legs in anything we could find to keep the snow out. We had pants which went to the knee and knit stockings that went above the knee and over our underpants. The stockings were scratchy, but I was always so thankful to have protection from the snow that the stockings didn't bother me. We had nothing to put over our shoes. I had my first rubbers when I was fourteen years of age. The rubbers had a buckle over the instep. We were rich, indeed, with our rubbers that went sliding over the snow and ice. We were the envy of many kids. Father bought the rubbers in Salt Lake City. He bought a pair for each of his children. Our shoes were made by Brother Aldridge Thorley, an excellent craftsman. Shoes cost \$1.50 a pair then, and were made to measure.

When Sister Chaffin stopped teaching she used the school room for part of her home, and the school moved elsewhere. There were many teachers then, some who knew very little more than the pupils, and others who were a great help in teaching the boys and girls.

After Mrs. Chaffin's School, my mother was our teacher. Since she had been trained as a teacher in England, she could fill in our education where it was needed. She would spend time with us, having us read to her, and then would read to us. We were always taught to be busy. When not doing physical labor we were to be sewing or reading. Mother would read Kipling and other great authors to us in her beautifully modulated voice. She would correct our spelling and speaking.

Every time we picked up broken English words from the settlers from many nations who lived in Cedar City, Mother would correct us and make us hold strictly to correct pronunciation of English words. She would say, "It is 'with,' not 'widdt'." In Cedar City there were English, Welsh, Scotch, Irish, Danes, Swedes, Dutch, Germans, and perhaps others in addition to Norwegians and Swiss. We children learned to speak the brogues of each and became great mimickers. Brother William was the best mimic in our private family. His son Lanell has maintained a similar talent.

The opportunities presented themselves constantly for us to learn the Indian language, but we never did learn it. Indians were repulsive to us. They would come to our home and sit on our porch. The flies would swarm around the Indians, and the rags and dirt would give us an idea that we wanted to copy nothing from them. Mother learned their language and was kind to them. She would carry on conversations with them and had understanding of their language, their plight, and their needs and did what she could to aid them.

It seems the best time of my life was hearing people speak in their broken English. We would go to Fast Meetings and hear the brethren speak in their native tongues, in broken English, and even "in tongues." I look back on those days as being very precious to me. I knew the Gospel to be true because those fine old people said it was true. There were no doubts nor misgivings for those men, and they passed their strength to those who listened. With great power they would declare the gospel to be true. Even Sister Chaffin added greatly to my religious life. Each morning she would say, "We're going to have a little prayer." She would then say a sweet prayer that seemed as if she were talking to God in our behalf. I loved her for those prayers.

My schooling was continued when I attended the Parowan Stake Academy. The academy was the whole top of the Knell Block building. It was a church school and was founded as a branch of Brigham Young College. Brother Karl G. Maeser came to Cedar City to help found the school. Brother Mayhew Dalley was a strong force in getting the school established. He was a great exponent of education.

The academy lasted only a short while, for people saw what education would do and many of the young people went to Provo to attend the BYC. So many went that there were not enough left for the Parowan Stake Academy. I couldn't go to Provo; we were too involved. I was needed at home and at the homes of my married brothers and sisters, so that my formal education ended with the Parowan Stake Academy.

My formal education helped me get the only "paying" job I ever had as Violet Lunt. The first newspaper I remember was run by Bernard Maeser, son of Dr. Karl G. Maeser. He had his newspaper shop in the back of the building where the Parowan Stake Academy was located. A friend and I applied for a job and we got it because we were good spellers. Working in the newspaper was a very happy time for me. We had to set type by hand, upside down and backwards. Some people thought that working in a newspaper office was not a suitable job for a girl. Being a typesetter was looked down on by some, but when I washed and scrubbed the ink from my hands, no one could tell what kind of work I did. Everyone else had to do the same - wash and scrub to be clean. I could not see that it made any difference what I did, so loved my work despite talk against it. We worked after school in the spring and during the summer, then Mr. Maeser moved and my job was ended.

This was my first job at which I earned money and the \$3.00 a week pay seemed enormous. How happy I was to get my first pay and run to the Sheep Store and buy a pair of shoes. They cost \$3.00 - my entire week's pay. The joy I felt at getting a new pair of shoes all my own with my own money cannot be understood, except by people who had obtained their shoes as we had. Much of the time we had to use one another's shoes. When I was about eleven or twelve, Aunt Ellen's shoes were too little for me, so that I could no longer use her shoes. It had been such a pleasure to wear her grown-up-looking shoes.

Often I was the shoe breaker-in. Sister Jane had some beautiful slippers and I was proud to be asked to break them in. They were so pretty that I was going to say they were mine, but Maud said, "They'll know you don't have any shoes." So that when I was seen wearing them and received compliments, I truthfully said, "I'm breaking them in."

In our family we learned early to be of service to others. One of our community services each of us gave as children was ringing the bell which called people to church. Father had built what we called a "turreter" on the top of our house, and in it was housed one of the first bells cast by the local iron works. The bell was in a belfry which was like a huge bird cage atop our house. A rope was attached to the bell and came down through the staircase well so that we need only go out into the hall to ring the bell. It was this bell which called people to church each Sunday and we children had the job of watching the clock and ringing the bell for Sunday School. As we gained enough stature to reach the rope, each of us had the privilege of ringing the bell, and it would remain our job until the next one was tall enough to reach the rope.

We had to ring the bell in rhythm. We would say, "one, tum te toe; two, tum te toe; three, tum e toe," up to ten. When we had "seven" with more than one syllable, we would drop one of the tune words. The bell would ring out loud and clear, and they could hear it all over town.

The bell was also used for funerals and although it was rung the same way, it seemed to have a mournful and dreary sound. We kept the bell until Father went to Mexico and then gave it up when our old home was sold.

There was also a fire bell. That one clanged and aroused our patriotic spirits. The fire bell was not in our house. It was rung from the Presbyterian Manse. There was an old Presbyterian lady, Miss Hartford, who kept a home for Presbyterians, although we had few of those. She used to have to go to Milford for her church services as there were so few Presbyterians here, but still the Presbyterians kept the home up. The Presbyterian's bell was not like our bell. It was on a framework outside of the home and was rung by hitting the bell so that its clapper clanged against the sides of the bell. When that bell would ring, everyone - children, men, and women - would get a bucket and run for the fire. Those with buckets would make a line from the canal to the burning home or barn. We had what we called canals running down each street. The canals were where we got our water for culinary puposes. As we lined up, a bucket of water would be passed from one person to another, and when it reached the people around the fire, the water would be used to put out the fire - if enough, and not too late. We did save many homes, but some were lost or badly damaged.

It was a great day and relief for aching backs, wrists, and shoulders when water was piped into the community. For years we filled barrels from the canal for our daily and weekly use. Each person had one, two, or more barrels sitting just inside their gates, which were their water systems. Most people used the water in the barrels Monday morning for their week's wash, and then the barrels would be refilled Monday evening for the week's supply of water.

Our washings were huge. They usually took 12 hours a day for the kind of washing we did. We would have two tubs, a first and second scrub tub. The clothes were then boiled, starting with cold water. We used to put water over ashes to obtain lye for our washing. After the boil there would be three rinses, sometimes more. Rinses were done in cold water too.

Our slips and panties were made from factory, and they must be scrubbed until thoroughly clean. To make sure they were clean, it was our practice to separate the seams and scrub along the selvaige to make sure there was no clinging lint or dirt within the garment which might be carried over from one wash to another.

On the mountains the washings were done outside with boiling batches put on an outside open kettle, but in town we didn't wash at all outside. We had so much heat in town both inside and outside that it didn't matter where we did our washing.

We did, however, iron outside in the summer time. We could hardly carry those hot crimping and other irons, but we would take them outside and iron on a bench. We would nearly die with the heat regardless, but Mother was usually putting up gooseberry preserves or other fruit and was using the inside foom for that activity.

In town we used clothes lines, but in the mountains we hung our clothes on nearby bushes and it looked as if we were having a real "flag day" with our washing draped over all available shrubbery surrounding our cabin. Sometimes our washings would be so huge that we'd have to resort to fences both in town and out of town.

We even had animals eat our clothes while in the mountains. If we saw one cow in particular going toward the bushes where the clothes were, we would yell, scurry to get sticks, call for help from the men, and hurry tro get the clothes in even if they were not dry.

Water for all puposes was not as easily come by as it is now. When we bathed, one would use the water, then it would be re-heated for the next person. Maud and I always used the same water.

Our drinking water was set on the north porch so that it would get the north breeze and help keep it cool. It was placed in a barrel and the barrel covered with wet burlap. We had a dipper hanging close by to use for drinking from the barrel. The drinking water was dipped up each morning. However, there were some days when there would be no water in the canal. This made it necessary for us to always be prepared and have water for more than one day's use. Winter made many problems with freezing both in the canal and barrel.

Our home was an interesting place. At first we had a home for just our private family - and our family was "private" some of the time. Mother had a plaque hanging on the wall which each of us memorized. We vied with each other for memorizing the plaquae and for other things. I can to this day run through the twelve sons of Jacob without hesitating. We memorized the ten commandments and other scriptures, all of which has had a great influence on us. For fun we would try to outquote each other at meal time.

Mother would aid us time after time in memorizing and would often add quotes of her own to help us see more clearly our duty as citizens, church members, and to help us along the straight and narrow. Here is what was contained on the plaque:

RULES TO BE OBSERVED BY THIS FAMILY

See Psalm CI.

As for me and my house, we will serve the Lord. -- Joshua XXIV, 15.

RISE EARLY

BE INDUSTRIOUS

GO EARLY TO BED

Yet a little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to sleep; so shall thy poverty come as one that travelth, and thy want as an armed man. -- Proverbs VI, 10-11.

Not slothful in business; fervent in spirit; serving the Lord. --Romans XII, 11.

Study to be quiet, and to do your own business, and to work your own hands. --1 Thessalonians IV, 11.

Six days shalt thou labor, and do all thy work. --Exodus XX, 9.

WASTE NOT, WANT NOT

Gather up the fragments that remain, that nothing be lost. --John VI, 12.

DO EVERYTHING AT ITS PROPER TIME.

PUT EVERYTHING IN ITS PROPER PLACE.

USE EVERYTHING FOR ITS PROPER USE.

BE PUNCTUAL.

BE REGULAR.

BE CLEAN.

Let all things be done decently and in order. Redeeming the time, because the days are evil.
--1 Corinthians XIV, 40; Ephesians, v. 16.

BE OBLIGING AND KIND ONE TO ANOTHER.

Be ye all of one mind, having compassion one of another; love as brethren. --1 Peter III, 8.

LET NO ANGRY WORD BE HEARD AMONG YOU.

Let all bitterness, and wrath, and anger, and clamor, and evil speaking be put away from you, with all malice; and be kind one to another, tender-hearted, forgiving one another, even as God, for Christ's sake, hath forgiven you. --Ephesians IV, 31-33.

BE TRUTHFUL, HONEST, AND HUMBLE

Lying lips are abomination to the Lord. --Proverbs XII, 22. (See also Ephesians XIV, 15, 25.)

Provide things honest in the sight of all men. --Romans XII, 17.

Pride goeth before destruction, and an haughty spirit before a fall. --Proverbs XVI, 18.

REMEMBER THE SABBATH DAY TO KEEP IT HOLY.

SEARCH THE SCRIPTURES.

WATCH AND PRAY.

In all thy ways acknowledge the Lord, and He shall direct thy steps. Proverbs III, 6.

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Our home was a two-storied brick building, with the belfry on top. There was a single hall with a staircase dividing the two sections. We lived in one half, Aunt Ellen in the other half. Later there was much added to our house, as it was turned into a hotel and a telegraph office.

Before the additions were made I can see my father pulling the sliding door, and on his feet were his dancing slippers. He was as nimble as a cricket and to us children he was a Prince Charming in his dancing shoes. He would dance with each of us, teaching us the polka, waltz, and all of the steps he knew. Those shoes were a symbol of the refined life he had been used to. During this period my father usually wore buckskin trousers and mocassins. But when he got dressed up, he was elegant in his long-tail broadcloth coat and his top silk hat. He would probably cause a sensation today, especially with the long-tailed coat, the mocassins, the silk hat and the buckskin trousers. It was the only way he had of blending the refined old country with the rigors and hardships and sacrifices of his pioneer existence here.

The clothes we children wore were made from our mother's clothes. Our dresses formed a "fatty" or basque over the hips. The skirts were glorified with ruffles and shirring - to the floor. The back had a sort of fold which we called a bustle. We couldn't sit when we had a bustle on. It was just like making a fancy form for a house, and then make a dress to fit it.

To black our shoes was a real ritual. We learned from where on the stove plate the soot best suited for blacking could be obtained. We tried to beat others to that particular place where the soot had accumulated. We would mix the soot with water, wet a shoe brush and then dab the soot on our shoes. When the soot was properly dried, we would brush and brush until our shoes shined like mirrors. I don't remember when we didn't have shoe brushes, but I do not know where my parents obtained them.

Aunt Ellen made the boys' suits, their shirts, and all of their clothing.

We kept our dresses long until some of the local women would go to Salt Lake City. When they returned we would learn that our dresses were too long for the city, so that we would shorten our skirts a little when the word got around. We tried to dress according to the city styles, and would be envious of the church leaders' daughters when they came to Cedar City in their high style clothes and their cut bangs and other new feminine styles. We were partakers, and the Lord forgive us for following styles.

I remember President Taylor's daughter coming to Cedar City. She had a dress that was twelve lengths wide at the bottom. My brother Will danced with her, and her dress filled almost the entire floor. She could hardly get so much material around her tiny waist. Her waist was so small, pulled in with heavy stays, that it looked as if a rounded forefinger and thumb could encircle it.

When bang style came out, we were all anxious to try it. One older lady would preach against it every opportunity she had. She would talk in meeting and put the most gruesome story before us that we would be cursed with scabs and would become bald. Mother would say, "Now, girls, if you are going to cut your hair a little, curl it and make it pretty. Tuck the ends under and then push it back away from your brow. Don't have your hair covering your brow."

I wanted bangs in the worst way, so that I said to my sister, "Florence, cut just a little here and there so I'll have some pretty curls." Florence cut some short bangs across my forehead and oh, was I happy! I took my two long braids and wound them around and around so that only the little bangs showed underneath. Mother said, "I'm glad you are happy, now you will sing better in the choir."

Our private home gave way to a public home and then our lives changed somewhat. At the time the Cattle and Sheep Corporation was organized our brother had to care for the animals. Mother went to Enoch to take care of the boys, and while she was away Father added 16 rooms to the back of our house. With this addition we had the Lunt Hotel.

In our old parlor a telegraph office was placed, and it also became a place for men to sit. Father was then in business.

We made a place for the stage coach in the back of our lot. There were two lots together and in the lot he kept grain stacks and animals in the very back of the lot. There was room for the big stage coaches, and then there was an orchard, where we raised apples, peaches, plums, apricots, and gooseberries from year to year. Down the center was an alleyway with a picket fence. Along the picket fence were the most beautiful hollyhocks that ever bloomed. The seeds were brought from England and they were a delight all of our lives. When I see hollyhocks now I feel as if I am looking upon something sacred and that they are growing upon hallowed ground. People now seem not to have the love for hollyhocks that we had. They say they are old-fashioned, their stalks get dry, they are a nuisance, and many other things are said of them. People saying such things are those who didn't grow up when hollyhocks were the pride of those who had or could obtain seed.

I have a business card which Father used for his hotel. It reads:

Henry Lunt, House of Entertainment.
One Block East of Main Street, Cedar City, Iron Co.
Good Accommodations for Utah Travelers and Visitors, at Reasonable Rates.
Hay, Grain, and Stabling.
Telegraph Office on the Premises.

We kept the mail drivers, who were our regular customers. The stage coach stopped at our hotel and brought us customers, and then there were many other customers. We had the Church visitors stay with us too. Father was bishop for 25 years and was also stake president. Because of Father's activities he saw the need for a stopping place and went to work to provide one.

Peculiar characters came to stay at our house, both before and after we had the hotel.

There was an old Russian we called "the old dumpling man." He carried a green umbrella and wore a broad-brimmed hat. He spoke in guttural tones and would ask us many questions. We were taught to answer politely to him and others, but we were admonished not to offer any information. This man would say in his deep-throated, guttural way, "Please make me an apple domplink." That is why we called him the dumpling man. We did not know what his business was. He would walk around town and stand and admire the old cottonwood trees and would observe people at their work.

A Grandma Jackson who was English, and just from the Shires, stayed with us. She would sit under the trees, husk corn, clean carrots, or anything. She was with us for several years, but she just went out of our lives, and I do not know what became of her.

There was Totty Pearsall, who was an old Englishman, or he may have been from someplace in northern Europe. He was comical, old, undesirable. He didn't know how to do things, but was ever present.

Where these and other people like them came from, I do not know. It seemed, however, that whenever a "lost" person or a misfit came to Utah, Brigham Young would send them to Father. No one knew what their business was, but we made it our business to take care of them and help them along. This became the job of the entire family and not just Father's responsibility.

As a child and a young person growing up, we each lived under a strain. We never had the freedom that youth have today, or even what some of our contemporaries had. We were always told not to talk too much, but to answer questions politely. We were to say, "Yes, sir," and "No, sir." We were not to ask questions of others, but to be interested and listen quietly if they wished to tell us things. We were never to repeat a confidence, and any trust given to us was to be held sacred.

We had others come to stay with us who were a joy and for whom we looked forward to their coming. There was Brother Nephi L. Pratt, a drummer. He would stay with us and teach us much while he was with us. He used to sing and teach us songs. We learned nice little sayings from him. When Brother Pratt came to our dining room we were highly entertained.

One time after I was married, Brother Pratt was at Mother's when I was visiting her. After I had gone home, he came down our street. John, my husband, saw him and said, "Is that the man you say had nice things to sell when you were at your mother's?" I answered, "Yes, that is Brother Pratt." John went out and bought a Mexican drawn-work tablecloth, for which he paid \$5.00. I was delighted, and to make the purchase of the table cloth from Brother Pratt something special and to show my appreciation to John, each Easter I would pick dandelions and put them in a bowl on a table covered with the cloth. I'd then invite people in for Easter dinner, and we always had a wonderful time.

The telegraph office turned out to be a blessing for most of our private family. Aunt Ellen first operated the telegraph. Henrietta was assistant operator until she married. Then Florence operated after Henrietta and Mama also became an operator. Finally it came Maude's turn. All of us learned to be telegraphers, and we would substitute for Aunt Ellen or whoever was supposed to be on duty.

I remember many times answering the telegraph call. Across the wires would come, "Are you M. L.?" I would answer, "No, this is V. L." Whoever was on the other end sending a message would say: "Please get M. L." Sometimes they had to be disappointed when Maude wasn't available and have me receive the message.

Mother too took her turn at the telegraph office, but after Maude's marriage, she and her husband took over the office and she ran it while she was rearing her eight children.

Because of Father's activity in the church and in town, as we grew older we saw less and less of him, so that it was Mother who had the main responsibility of the family. Father, however, was a wonderful father and looked after us with a great deal of concern and interest, but our time with him grew shorter as he became involved in his various duties.

A flood of memories come to me about my brothers and sisters, all of whom I loved. Our brothers and sisters in our private family became more and more involved with our family and they began to loom as very important individuals to each other.

Maude has been a particular joy to me. We were close as children and that closeness has remained through the years. She is now 84 and we have had many happy hours together. When we now piece quilts or work on genealogy together, we recall for each other many sweet and happy memories. Some of the memories bring tears to our eyes, for our lives have tasted bitterness as well as sweetness. Through it all I keep wondering if I have become the kind of person my mother and my brothers and sisters would have me become.

Mother always referred to Maude and me as "the little girls," even after we were grown. She said we were carbon copies of Henrietta and Eva. I was like Henrietta and Maude like Eva. Our beautiful and talented sister Florence had no one that was an exact carbon copy of her.

When we were little, and when we were grown, I slept with Mother half of the time, Maude the other half.

When I am tempted a vision of Mother comes to me, and I realize I must still abide by her teachings. I always felt inferior to my mother. As I look back, I wonder if during my lifetime I have truly developed the character she would have had me develop. Even today when I walk down the street admiring displays in the store windows, as I see the lovely goods, I'll catch a glimpse of myself reflected in the window. I automatically think: "Shoulders straight, hips back, head erect," and the final admonition, "Am I developing a good form for a woman and have the womanly carriage I should?" These words were often spoke to me by my mother as she tried to help me develop into a worthwhile woman.

After Father went to Mexico, Mother taught school to make an addition to our house. What she earned paid for a kitchen and an extra bedroom. Jed Jones, Eva's husband, built her a pretty little entrance to the home. This house was the Will MacFarlane home later, and is still standing. Before Will MacFarlane owned the home, our brother Will bought the home. The money he paid for purchasing it was unselfishly sent by Mother to Mexico to aid those of the family in Mexico. Mother then built a house on what is now a parking lot east of the city and county building. In this home Mother and Maude lived, and Maude lived in it after she was married. Jed Jones encouraged Mother and helped her in many ways. He would see that she had a load of wood. He would help her with her building problems, and it was he that encouraged her to teach school in order to get needed additions and repairs to her homes.

Mother was an actress. She would participate in many plays. I remember one - I believe it was "The Rosemaric Veil." Mother was supposed to be stabbed while on stage. After the supposed stabbing, she said something, then pressed something against her to squeeze out something red to make it appear to be blood. Maude, watching the performance for the first time, screamed out: "My mamma's hurt, she's been killed!"

I have known all of the presidents of the Church except the Prophet Joseph Smith. President Young used to come to our home and he has held me on his knee many times. President Taylor was one of the chums at our home and his daughter Eleanor set the pattern in many things for us to follow, particularly in dress and hair style.

President Young ordained Father a patriarch to all the church wherever he went. Father gave over 1000 blessings, and we all had blessings from Father. The blessings Father gave are now contained in a volume in the Church Historian's office. Father came from Mexico once a year to meet with the General Authorities in Salt Lake City. It was while he was on one of these trips that he gave my husband and me our blessings.

President J. Reuben Clark, Jr., taught school in Cedar City and was a companion to my brothers who were here, and when he went to Mexico as United States ambassador, my brothers there knew him.

Henry, my oldest brother, took on the responsibilities of a man at a very early age. He was only ten years old when he began going with Father when Father performed his public duties. Henry was a smart boy with horses, but sometimes he was busy doing other things for Father so that Henrietta, who was also smart with horses, would drive Father about. The last time I saw Henrietta handling horses was when she was correcting sons in the way to handle horses.

Randle was the middle one of the three boys. He was not only middle in position, but was in the middle of our family relations. Sweet old Randle was a go-between. When we were little, if we got bumped or hurt in any way it was Randle to whom we went. Often I have crept in bed with Randle to be comforted. The first money I ever had was from dear Randle. When I have told others that Randle gave me the first money I ever had, they have said, "But Randle didn't ever have any money." My answer could easily be, "No, he gave it to others to ease their sorrow and pain." Randle's Kate died in childbirth on the mountains July 24. John and I were to go to the mountain and take some ice with us for ice cream. Half the town was on the mountain for the celebration, but there was no ice cream nor celebration when we learned the news of Kate's death in child-bearing.

Will was the comedian of our family. He always looked on the lighter side of life. He made a lot of fun for all of us. Will was also the dancer of the family. While we girls inherited Mother's singing talent, Will inherited Father's skill at dancing. Will would take each of us and whirl us in a lively dance. He taught us all of the new dance steps and helped us to know the waltz. In the absence of Father, Henry was the "boss" of the home.

Our brothers, even when they were little fellows, used to spend their play hours working. They gathered cobble rock from the creek as one of their leisure-time activities. They brought enough rock home to make a cobblestone-paved wide, wide driveway into our yard. Our boys worked especially hard each year at harvest time and after. They worked hard helping the Indians stage an exchange place in our yard. Father was particularly good to the Indians and at fruit time the Navajos would stay in our yard. Father would say to the boys, "It is time for the Navajos. We had better get prepared." The boys would then go to the fields, get fresh hay, and line our yard along the fences with the hay. The Navajos would then tie their horses around the fence where the hay was.

The Indians would come wrapped in their colorful blankets and with additional blankets to sell. They would also have fresh trout to offer to anyone interested in buying it. The trout would be wrapped in wet willow and grass. People would come as far away as Pioche to buy the fish and blankets. The Indians were permitted to glean the fruit from our orchard and those of other people also.

We often did things as part of a family. When I was about 12, Florence, Mother, and I went to St. George, where Florence and I enrolled in Annie Milne's School. We studied art and needle work. Sister Florence could not stay to complete the course as she soon had to return to take over the telegraph office. Mother and I stayed until I had completed the course in the school. On our return home we stayed in Washington, then went to Bellview (now Pintura) the second night. The second morning we got up so early that I left my nightgown in Mr. Gregerson's home, where we had stayed. Years after, when we had students who attended school here stay with us, Annie Gregerson came to stay with us. She was the granddaguter of the man whose home we had slept in and where I had left my nightgown.

We girls had many temptations. Millionaires tempted us with money, and if it had not been for our teachings, we may have yielded to the temptations placed before us. One of the most harassing experiences occurred with a traveler. When I was small it was my duty to black Henry's shoes. Florence and I were in the kitchen one day attending to this duty. Henry was upstairs getting ready to go someplace. The stage coach had just arrived and a man came into our house. He inquired about the family and we answered his questions. We must have indicated that no one was home. He told us that he wanted to see the part of the house that was a cellar under the kitchen. Florence took him down the ladder to show it to him. While down there, he attempted to molest her. She ran up the ladder, grabbed a stove poker to beat him off, and I ran to the meeting house and told Father what was taking place. Florence had beat the man until her hands bled. Brother Tucker, our town marshal, got a posse together and the man was rode out of town - far enough to catch the stage coach, which had gone on.

When I was nine I was detailed with Evan Williams, who was then ten or eleven years of age, to drive the hogs from the mountain to Cedar City. We drove about 35 pigs from Jones Hollow to Cedar City. We started before daylight. The pigs would get in a bunch and we had to press them hard to keep them moving. We whistled and sang to get them to go along. We would come to a creek and the baby pigs couldn't cross. We would pick them up to help them move, and the mother pigs would bare their teeth and come after us. We would throw the little pigs down or over the creek, and the mothers would then root and dig, and we'd have to start our driving campaign all over again.

It seems a reflection on the men folk that they would require two young people to get the pigs to Cedar City. We would be very tired, and as we came to some green grassy spots we would want to stop in the shade, but we couldn't for we had to keep driving the pigs relentlessly all day long in order to get them to Cedar City by nightfall. Sometimes the hired help, as Oriah Leigh and others, would get away from work early and come to meet us and offer us help. This was not required of them and the men folk didn't like the hired help making babies of us. The years of driving pigs put me in fine fettle to be in condition to drive Lehi Jones' calves down from the mountain when I was 14. One early morning Lehi got me up and told me to drive the calves down the mountain. When I was helping Henrietta, he would often get me up early and have me put in a day's work for him driving animals, shucking corn, or doing other farm work before I was free to help Henrietta.

It wasn't all work and drudgery, although it seems as if that was what it was most of the time. We had fun despite the hard work. I wrote a poem for a celebration in honor of Lehi, and in it I told of Poots Walker, who was always after Lehi for a job. I told of the fun we had always had together. Maybe the hardships I endured are what makes me so tough. I was born and bred in it.

Lehi was wise in many ways. When Willard Jones went out in the valley to farm, Lehi said to him, "You build a house on that corner, and it will hold the land for you." And it did hold the land for Willard, and he became one of the large landholders and great farmers of Escalante Valley.

When the Cedar City boys and girls went off to Provo to school, Maude and I could not go. It was understood that Henrietta and Eva couldn't spare us. They were both married and needed us. We never worked in business places or went away to work, for we accepted it as our responsibility to help our married sisters. I helped Henrietta, and Maude helped Eva. We tended the children and helped with all the work, and our pay was only something like a dress slipped to us once in a while.

Even at a very young age I could see that environment doesn't produce the same types of individual. I cannot analyze it now, nor could I then, but with two brothers marrying two sisters, one would expect their home life and their children to be somewhat alike. Instead, Henrietta and Eva's lives were very different.

Eva's children are easy and comfortable, and they enjoy life. Henrietta's children are always on the push. It seems not to matter how comfortable their circumstances are, they must give all their effort to whatever they are doing and try to gain greater comforts and improvement.

Jed Jones, Eva's husband, treated Eva like a queen. Nothing was too good for her, and he must provide it with as little effort on her part as possible. He was always trying to do something special for her. I remember the first bottled fruit in Cedar City. Jed brought three empty two-quart bottles from Salt Lake City. He made an extra shelf in the "secretary," on which to display them. Eva filled them with peaches, plums, and apricots; and upon the top shelf of the secretary they went. Up to that time, everyone preserved fruit in earthenware crocks.

Lehi Jones, Henrietta's husband, was a worker, and he expected the same for his wife, his family, and everyone around him. He would leave his family with all kinds of work to be done, and Henrietta had to buckle down and do it or see that the children took the responsibility and did a share of it.

I was with Henrietta through the birth of some of her children. I recall when Lehi was born. Henrietta wanted to go out and see the lovely straw. We walked toward the corral and were admiring the straw when Henrietta told me she wanted to be alone in the yard. I went back into the house to see what Ann was doing, and as I got almost to the house, Henrietta called me back. She was ill. Mother was sent for and the doctor came. Mother was the nurse, and I took the place of a hired girl and did the doctor's and Mother's bidding. We had a hard time pulling Henrietta through as she gave birth to Lehi.

Besides the horror of the uncertainty of Henrietta's recovering, I remember the mammoth washing that we put out at that time. Henrietta had no washing machine, and everything must be scrubbed by hand on a wash board. The sheets became a mounting task day after day. We had no sanitary napkins or effective means of controlling hemorrhages, and the sheets showed it. We used newspapers, rags, everything to control the staining of the sheets, but each day the task was the same. I would wash and scrub out the big sheets, then Mother and I would take them out to the lucerne patch and spread them out so that the sun could bleach them. We would leave them for two or three days, then back to the house we'd take them. Again I would scrub and wash, and then put them in the boiler and boil them a long time before they would be rinsed and hung upon the line. In my memory I can still feel the aches in my wrists and arms. Sometimes I thought my wrists were broken, but the next day I would go through the process again.

While I was with Henrietta at different times, I had many experiences which required skill and know-how, both of which I seemed to lack. Henrietta had a goiter and was to take some gargling medicine for it. One of her sisters-in-law had taken some formaldehyde over to her home and placed it with the medicines. Henrietta mistakenly took the formaldehyde and swallowed some. We called Dr. Robertson, and he told us to give yeast or mustard water and he'd be right over. By the time Dr. Robertson got there Henrietta was numb. She recovered, but she was critical for two or three days, and we were grateful when she showed signs of recovery.

Henrietta had a great amount of illness. She had almost continuous tooth aches. There were no dentists, so that she had a terrible time getting her teeth out, and then she had a terrible time getting them in - false ones to take her natural teeth's place.

When I told Henrietta that I was going to get married, her first words were: "Oh, my goodness, what will I do?"

From my diary: "At the age of 12 years I was invited by our chorister, Joseph Cosslett, to join the ward choir, which was a great honor and one which I have always considered a sacred responsibility. The choir took part in all public functions, both civic and religious, which required constant training. Several evenings each week were devoted to practice."

Singing in the choir was a great source of joy throughout my life. It is only in recent years that I have given up choir singing. It seems that even though there is an urge to sing, age has its way of making a voice less vigorous and sweet. I can hear my own voice and know that it isn't as good as it was, nor are the notes as true.

While in the choir I had the privilege of singing in the same concert as Emma Lucy Gates, a great American singer and a member of our Church. Sister Gates came to Cedar City for a concert, and the choir sang some numbers to complete the program. My sister Florence and I sang a duet as one of the numbers. Florence always sang the lead, and I was "second."

I never did know how Sister Gates felt about our singing, for when our numbers were through I went to sit in the balcony with my husband. I wanted to get the full benefit of Sister Gates' singing, and thought I could enjoy it best sitting in the audience with John. After the concert there were too many surrounding her for me to get close, but I did see that some of our aspiring young singers and their sponsors had her "button-holed." I would have been just another person offering her congratulations had I made my way to her. I felt embarrassed and sorry that the great singer was subjected to such superlatives in behalf of some of our would-be singers.

The choir was truly an institution in Cedar City. We were called upon to sing at everything from funerals to picnics. If any dignitaries came to town, we were called upon to entertain them. On each occasion Brother Cosslett would close up his store and come dressed up wonderfully. His dress and demeanor gave us a key to the importance of each occasion. He was a wonderful choir leader. He had led a boys' choir in England and used every bit of his training to make ours a choir of distinction. Songs were selected from the masters, but for fun and variety Brother Cosslett would have many songs which the entire community loved. I look over the Church song books today and wonder why they have eliminated so many of the wonderful hymns. The people need them today as much as we needed them. They were an inspiration to us, and would be for today's boys and girls. Many which I believe would fit our times have been taken out.

Brother Cosslett's favorite song was "Uphold the Right." The community's favorite was a

round called "The Bill of Fare." It seems a shame that such a wonderful song should be lost. Not a soul seems to know it now. I can recall part of it and can sing the tune and even add the beautiful full notes of the bass of the chorus. The song had color, modulation, and resonance. There were many verses.

A waiter would come out and sing "Where's the crowd?" and the crowd - or the chorus rather - would sing, "What's the bill of fare?" All answers and questions fitted into the song musically and beautifully. The verses would be as this one:

Oysters on the half shell,
Chicken stew and dumplings,
Sauerkraut with pigs' feet
And mulligatawny stew.

Then would come the beautiful bass with:

Beans, potatoes, cabbage head,
Strong coffee, meat, ice cream, corn bread.

That round would get the people's feet dancing, and they would show their delight in their faces and manner.

The round was always sung at community dinners. The community dinners were something to remember. People would bring baskets of food and dishes. The women would prepare the food, and the men would prepare the tables. We usually had three long tables, and everyone in the community - even those of other faiths, if there were any - were invited too. Our choir would often serve as waiters and as we served we would sing "The Bill of Fare."

Our choir sang at funerals, the saddest days of which were during the flu epidemic in 1918-19. We would go to the homes of the bereaved and sing on the porches. I recall one sad occasion when we were singing the snow flakes came so thickly that we could hardly see. We all had umbrellas over us so that the pages of our books would not become wet, but our tears wet the pages even if the snow flakes didn't. Funerals were arranged quickly then. If a person were to die in the night time, by afternoon all arrangements would be made, and the funeral held. Some of the men in our choir were coal miners. They would hurry to the mines in the morning and be back in time for the afternoon funeral.

In addition to singing, we women worked hard to prepare the burial clothing for the dead. We would be called early in the morning. One of the sweet old sisters would go to the home and measure the body for clothing. She would take the measurements to one of the women in charge of sewing, and then the committee would get together and do the work. My sisters and I were among the sewers as well as among the singers.

Sister Palmer and I used to go into the homes and help people during the flu epidemic. We had no phones and went from house to house to let people know there had been a death.

Most of the time our choir had unity and love for one another. Brother Cosslett had some ideas about how people should be. In addition to the messages contained in our songs, he often gave us messages. He would say, "Don't let a day pass without doing some good." "Let not this day pass without some job well done," and "Before the sun goes down make friends if you have enemies."

Few of us had any real musical training, except such as we could get from our parents and others who understood a little music. Brother A. N. Tollestrup, who came to Cedar City as a teacher of music for the Branch Normal School, became accompanist for the choir. He took a few of us and taught us to us became good enough so that we could pick out tunes on the organ.

I was one selected to be taught by Brother Tollestrup. Even though I had been taught to use the music, I usually played by ear, but no one seemed to know the difference. By playing by ear I could add the bass, tenor, alto or soprano parts and embellish them as I had always heard them played and sung.

Because of the training I received as a choir member, when I taught Sunday School, Primary, or was in Relief Society, I was usually an assistant organist, and I was always grateful for that opportunity. While teaching the primary class in Sunday School, my friend and I asked for an organ. The ward purchased a beautiful little organ for us, and I used to play it for the primary class. I taught the class for many years. We had wonderful times together, and the children loved the music.

But not all little boys liked the music well enough to want to come to the class. I remember one little boy being brought by his sister, but no amount of coaxing by his sister would stop him from digging his heels in the ground and shouting that he didn't want to go to that class. His sister dragged him in anyway, and within a month we had him singing along with the rest of us. This boy soon became our star singer, for he had a wonderful natural talent. We had him in a matter of weeks appearing on a program singing a duet with my niece. They sang, "Cindy, Cindy."

When I was president of the Primary Association we had operettas and cantatas frequently. The children loved them and so did the parents. We put on as many as one operetta or musical a month. We put on "Cinderella" and many other appealing musicals. We would have all hundred of the Primary children participate. It had a heavenly look and sound to have those sweet children singing and participating on the programs.

Much of my success in teaching children was due to my experience and training in the choir. I was a choir member for over 50 years and never missed a practice or a time when we were asked to sing before a group. During the summer, when people were on the mountains, the choir did not perform much, except for special programs as the Fourth of July.

We participated in many special programs, as Evan Stephens came down occasionally and would invite our choir to go to Salt Lake City for general conference. Often we would have members selected to go to Salt Lake City to sing as a trio, quartet, or small choral groups.

The choir filled a great part of my life and I had many happy moments as a singer, so that it was indeed a sad day when I decided to give up singing in the choir. By the time I gave up singing, our community had grown so that there were many choirs, one for each ward, and our old town choir, which had begun as a ward choir, was no longer in existence. I did, however, sing in the ward choirs long after the town choir had been replaced.

Now comes that part of my story which seems to have had the greatest influence on my reaching the degree of maturity I now have. This phase of my life has to do with the love I had for John Urie and that which he had for me. I have loved him for 71 years, almost 45 of which we were married and two of which we spent in courtship. The rest has been widowhood. I have never ceased to love him, and I am looking forward to the time when we can be together again. Although I have had attention from other men since John passed away, I have been repelled by even the thought of remarriage or having a semblance of a courtship with anyone else.

I first saw John coming through the trees on a beautiful white horse. He appeared as if he were a Prince Charming riding to rescue a fair maiden - although I was never fair. I was the dark one of the family. I was reclining on a low tree trunk. It was a Sunday afternoon, and as I had no specific work to do because of the Sabbath, I had taken a book and was reading in the forest. Our family was on the mountain doing dairy work at that time.

I heard a noise and looked up from my book, and there was the most exciting man I have ever seen coming toward me on his beautiful horse. Although our town was small, and we seemed to know almost everyone, I had never known John Urie. This man riding toward me was a complete stranger. He stopped and we talked. Before he left he asked me for a horseback ride date.

As young women we never rode astride a horse. We would sit sideways, one foot in a stirrup, one leg raised a little, and we'd hold on to the saddle horn to help us keep our balance.

John and I rode Dan and Dagen - soft prancers, who we had after our marriage, too. I rode Dan. He was a sorrel horse. On one of our rides I fell off, and I cried all night because John had probably seen my petticoats. The fall and petticoats must not have made any difference, for when we moved back to town in the fall, John asked me for a real dancing date. He made it sound matter-of-fact as he said, "Since they are opening the academy and they are going to hold open house with a dance, let's go and see what it is like."

The writer of the current song says, "I could have danced all night," and he must have known how it feels on a first dancing date with someone you are falling in love with. I could have danced all night with John, but there were lots better dancers than John. He said many times to me, "Let the better dancers take you." But from then on I never dated anyone else. Prior to the time that I met John I had had little dates, like going to an afternoon dance, riding on horseback dates, walk home, and carry book dates, and sit on the bridge dates, but nothing really special. One of the favorite places for youngsters to go and teenagers too, was on the bridge at the head of the street. We would sit on the bridge and let our feet dangle down to nearly touch the water underneath. We walked to the bridge together, we went singly and met our friends there, and sometimes ended a pleasant afternoon or evening on the bridge.

John and I were married in the St. George Temple, June 14, 1892. It was a Tuesday. I was 19 and John was 23 years of age.

I didn't have much of a trousseau, but what I had was both practical and beautiful. One lady who had taken a liking to me came to our home to help me make some aprons. Mother was indignant and told her, "We can provide for our daughters when they get married." I was grateful and touched, but Mother showed her English pride and wasn't willing to have a daughter accept what she considered charity. My sisters and sisters-in-law for whom I had worked added some items to my trousseau. My wedding outfit consisted of a suit of underwear which was solid embroidery. My dress was organdy.

It took us two days to go to St. George for the wedding ceremony. We took only nine hours, however, to go from Hamilton's Fort to St. George the second day. The first day was Sunday. Sunday evening John, Mother, Liza Webster, John's sister, and I went in a white-topped buggy to John's father's place near Hamilton Fort. Pulling the load was John's beautiful team, Mac and Coaly. John's mother had died the year before, and his father was living in Hamilton's Fort with his second wife, "Aunt Pricilla." I had to sleep with Mother. She talked all night, telling me all the things a young bride should know and saying how sorry she was to "lose" me, but that it shouldn't make any difference to us.

We were to continue to be the best of mothers and daughters anyway. Mother needn't have talked all night. I was starry-eyed, and anything she said was lost in my own apprehensions, yet burning, burning love I had for John.

At 5 a. m. Monday we were on our way to St. George. The horses traveled beautifully and we made record time - nine hours. We arrived fairly early and had the afternoon and evening to rest.

We didn't rest, however, for we stayed with Aggie Winsor, and she had only a little house, and many people to accommodate. All she had for us was a little sofa - one that pulled out - and we didn't take any extra bedding, so that there wasn't much we could do.

John said, "Violet and I can stay up all night." The elders were shocked, but he was just making a joke. I never saw anyone who could quite come up to John. He always had a twinkle in his eyes, and he made the most of every situation.

I slept with Mother again, but I didn't get much sleep again that night. We were in that small house where everyone could almost see everyone else, and I was afraid John might see me in my nightgown. I don't know why I worried, for the gown had long sleeves and the neck was up around my throat.

In the morning we got up early and John said, "Let's go down to the meadow." Everyone was worried lest we wouldn't get back in time to go to the temple, but the horses needed watering, and John had to do it, so there was no reason why I shouldn't go along and make it a more pleasant task.

"President Wilford Woodruff and company were visiting the temple so that we were honored in having George Q. Cannon, a counselor to President Woodruff, perform our marriage ceremony. He being a close friend of our families." So says my diary.

After the ceremony we got in the whitetop drawn by the elegant and spirited team, Mac and Coaly. We went directly back to John's father's and Aunt Pricilla's place near Hamilton's Fort.

Aunt Pricilla had a big dinner awaiting us. We had roast beef and cabbage, and ate popcorn and molasses candy. The table was not laid when we arrived, so I put the plates on the table, turning them upside down as was the custom in our family and many other families in which I had visited. Brother Urie saw what I had done and said, "Lassie, what does this mean? Am I not to eat?" I turned the plates back up after Aunt Pricilla told me that I must not turn the plates down for Brother Urie. When John's father visited our home I was always careful to hang the towels as he liked them, for Brother Urie was very particular, and never did I turn the plates when Brother Urie visited us.

John's sister and her husband had been living in the old Urie home. It was the home in which John had been born and reared. He being the youngest of the family, the home naturally fell to him; but John gave his father \$400.00 for the deed. Brother Urie had all of John's mother's things that her children wanted taken out of the home and given to the children. To replace what had been taken out and what we would likely need, Brother Urie went to Wood's store and bought articles for our home. We always lived in that home and had a wonderful time there. there.

John and I were preparing to celebrate our 50th wedding anniversary when he died. We had decided to play an organ duet on our anniversary. We had practiced some and looked forward to months of practicing together to make it perfect. He died, however, December 2, 1936, in the Iron County

Hospital of complications following an operation. He had an operation for an abscess in the intestines and liver.

During those 44 years we had some wonderful experiences, only some of which I shall mention.

We had been married over four years when we had an opportunity to adopt a beautiful baby girl. It had become apparent that we would not have children, and for that I was unhappy.

When my best friend, Belle Macfarlane Perry, had a girl, I was most unhappy for myself. I said, "Belle, you should let me have that baby, for I can't have any, and you can, and I am terribly unhappy." Belle answered, "I feel very sorry that you are unhappy, but I feel that perhaps this very day there is a baby born somewhere which is meant that you should be its mother, and I think you will get it." I was pleased that she wanted to comfort me and dropped the subject.

Several months later, through events which were not instigated by us but by some who knew us, the way was opened up for us to adopt our little daughter. She had been born in Salt Lake City, April 14, 1897, the very day that Belle had told me there was a child born somewhere for me. We went to Lund and got her from her mother. Her name was Marguerite. We adored her as only fond parents can love children. When fifteen months of age, Marguerite developed a fever which was pronounced to be typhoid. After a lingering illness she passed away, July 17, 1901.

We were much sorrowed by little Marguerite's passing. It was a disappointment to us, but we were still hopeful that we could have the joy of helping rear others who might need parental care. Our dreams and prayers were answered a few years later when we had Ramona, age 8, and Daniel, age 6, come to share our home. I was attracted to these lovely children long before I was privileged to have them come to live with us.

The Cedar choir had to sing at conference in Parowan. At that time, their father, Collins W. Clark, had passed away. He had been kicked by a horse while working in his corral at home. As we sat in the choir seats, I looked down and there I saw a young mother holding a baby and had a cluster of children around her. I asked who she was, and it was told me that she was a Mrs. Clark, whose husband had been killed and that those were her children, the youngest of whom had been born after the father died. She was Rose Brown Clark. I watched the little brood through the services and knew that I loved them.

Quite some time later a knock came at our door in Cedar City. I knew the knock was from a stranger, for it was at our front door instead of the side door. Everyone who knew us used our dining room door, which was on the south side of our house. When I opened the door, a man standing there said, "Mrs. Urie, you used to work in the telegraph office, so I know you."

I explained that it was Maude who did most of the telegraph work.

He said, "You are not Florence, for she was my girl." It seemed as if everyone knew Florence for her beautiful soprano voice and her prominence as a singer, but here was someone who knew her for something else.

I told the man, "No. I'm Violet."

He said, "But you are the one I want to talk to. I'm Edgar Clark, but I must talk to you when your husband is home. Is he here? I told him that John was not at home, but I would send for him if it

were important. "If it concerns me, I'd like to know about it now," I said.

Mr. Clark hesitated, then and told me it did concern me, but he thought it better to talk about it when John was with me. After some little while, he decided to tell me of his mission. He said that the Clark children had been left orphans by the death of their mother some time before and that the family had been getting along quite well. However, the grandparents felt that it would be better if different arrangement could be made. Kenneth, Hazel, Earl, and Gladys had been taking care of the three little ones, Ramona, Daniel, and Douglas. It was thought it would be better to have someone also take care of the three little ones. The grandmother wanted to keep the baby, who was now three years or so - at least for a while. Would I, he asked, be willing to care for Daniel and Ramona?

My heart skipped a beat or two, and I was overjoyed, but I told him John and I would talk it over and let him know. He said he would be visiting his daughter, Olivia Jones, and we could contact him at her place. When John came home that night we talked and planned all night. He was overjoyed, too, and could not rest for the planning we did that night. Next morning we told Mr. Clark we would take the children.

We received the children December 11, 1905. Mr. Clark said that a little money had been left over after settling the Clark estate and that we could have that money. We did not use the money for rearing the children. We put it in the bank for them, to be used toward their education or when they reached manhood and womanhood.

When Douglas was four, he came to Cedar City to live with Isaac and May Higbee. Their home was on Main Street, just a block east of our home; and Daniel and Douglas were privileged to grow up near each other. The four older brothers and sisters often came to stay with us. They made Cedar City their headquarters, mostly while attending school here, until they were married. Even after their marriages they made our home their headquarters.

Daniel and Ramona were not flesh of my flesh, but they grew into me like branches of a tree, and it was as if they were my own children. They became part and parcel of us. Their brothers and sisters were like branches being grafted into a tree, almost natural branches, but it took some time for them to be part of our family.

After the children came, one April 1 morning they came running to the back door calling, "Auntie, something has happened to the chickens." I rushed out and sure enough all of the chickens were lying down and there was not a head in sight. I no doubt showed my dismay.

They they cried, "April fool! April fool! Here, chickie. Come on, chickie." They had gotten up early, caught the chickens, put their heads under their wings and whirled them around so that they were all lying down. Then they had called me. John's dry comment was, "Just shows you can't tell what you see."

One day while on the way home from a visit in Parowan, Ramona saw a rooster cross the roadway. She said, "Uncle John, would you see if we can buy one?" John stopped the buggy and bought not only one, but two roosters for the children. Once he brought home a sack and wouldn't give it to the children until they guessed what was in it. Daniel immediately said, with his black eyes flashing, "A pup, a pup!" Yes, John had brought a pup home for the children. We were always finding some way to please and entertain them.